

The Merchant of Venice

Imagery in "The Merchant of Venice"

Imagery is important in a text because it adds another dimension to the text. It enhances and extends meaning. It often helps to develop character or theme. For the following, complete the image and explain its meaning. Think carefully about who is speaking and to whom.

Act and scene	Quotation	Technique and Meaning
Act I, scene I, lines 8-10	"Your mind is tossing on the ocean, There where your argosies with portly sail Like _____,"	
Act 1, scene 1, lines 148- 151	"To shoot another arrow that self way Which you did shoot the first, _____"	
Act 1, scene 1, lines 169- 172	"...her sunny locks Hang on her temples like a golden fleece... _____."	
Act I, scene III, line 36	"How like a fawning _____ he looks!"	

Act II, scene I, lines 15-16	"Besides, the _____ Bars me the right of voluntary choosing:"	
Act II, scene IX, lines 28-30	"...but like _____ Builds in the weather on _____, Even in the force and road of casualty."	
Act III, scene II, lines 44-45	"Then if he lose he makes a swan-like end, Fading _____."	
Act III, scene II, lines 121- 123	"The painter plays the spider, and hath woven a golden mesh _____ Faster than gnats in cobwebs."	
Act III, scene III, line 7	"But since I am _____, beware my fangs"	

Act IV, scene I, lines 115- 116	"...the weakest kind of fruit _____, and so let me,"	
Act IV, scene I, lines 180- 181	"The quality of mercy is not strain'd, It _____"	
Act V, scene I, lines 90-91	"How far that little candle throws his beams! _____."	